

OPS-001 | Shipment Escalation Policy

Risk classification, escalation timing, human approval, and audit requirements.

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Training Notice

This is a fictional internal policy created solely for portfolio development, testing, retrieval, and RAG evaluation. It does not describe the policy of any real carrier, customer, or logistics company.

1. Purpose

Define a consistent escalation process for shipments at elevated operational risk so that high-impact delays are reviewed quickly, actions are documented, and irreversible decisions remain subject to human approval.

2. Scope

Applies to active outbound and inbound shipments managed by Logistics Operations, Customer Operations, and the Operations Supervisor queue. The policy covers delayed, stalled, weather-impacted, misrouted, and high-risk shipments.

3. Risk classification

The AI Logistics Copilot may calculate an operational risk score, but the score is advisory. Operational actions must follow this policy and existing system permissions.

Risk level	Score	Expected handling
LOW	0-34	Normal monitoring. No escalation required unless a specific exception applies.
MEDIUM	35-69	Review during the current operating window; collect missing evidence and confirm next milestone.
HIGH	70-100	Operations Supervisor review required within 30 minutes. Prepare an escalation recommendation and supporting evidence.

Key retrieval fact: A shipment with a risk score of 70 or higher is classified as HIGH risk and requires Operations Supervisor review within 30 minutes.

4. Automatic escalation triggers

A shipment must be placed in the escalation review queue when any of the following conditions is confirmed:

- **Risk score ≥ 70 .**
- The shipment is explicitly marked **delayed** and the committed ETA has passed.
- No trusted shipment event has been received for **24 hours or more** while the shipment is in transit.
- A severe weather event affects the current route and the next delivery milestone is at risk.
- A customer-specific service commitment requires priority handling.
- There is evidence of loss, damage, misrouting, customs hold, or repeated carrier failure.

5. Required HIGH-risk review

The reviewing Operations Supervisor must inspect the shipment record, most recent trusted events, committed ETA, customer priority, carrier status, weather context when relevant, and any applicable operational procedure.

The reviewer must choose one of the following dispositions:

Disposition	Use when	Approval
Continue monitoring	Evidence suggests the issue is temporary and next milestone is credible.	Supervisor decision
Contact carrier	Carrier confirmation or revised ETA is required.	Supervisor decision
Notify customer	Delay materially affects a customer commitment.	Supervisor or authorized Customer Operations user
Route intervention	Rebooking, rerouting, recovery pickup, or equivalent intervention is needed.	Human approval required
Close escalation	Risk has resolved and evidence is documented.	Supervisor decision

6. Human approval requirement

The AI Logistics Copilot may propose an escalation, carrier contact, customer notification, or route intervention. It must not claim that the action was executed unless a human-authorized system action confirms execution.

Any action that changes a shipment route, carrier, delivery commitment, customer-facing promise, financial charge, or cancellation state requires explicit human approval.

7. Documentation requirements

- Record the reason for escalation in plain language.
- Include the risk score and the factors that contributed to it.
- Identify the source of operational facts used in the decision.
- Capture the reviewer name or system identity and review timestamp.
- If an action is proposed but not approved, preserve the proposal as pending or rejected; do not record it as executed.

8. Example

Shipment SHP-1010 is delayed, its ETA has passed, and its last trusted event is older than 24 hours. The deterministic risk engine returns a score of 90. The correct handling is to classify the shipment as HIGH risk, request Operations Supervisor review within 30 minutes, and prepare an escalation recommendation supported by the shipment record and

applicable procedures.

9. Exceptions

A Supervisor may downgrade urgency when the source data is known to be stale or incorrect, but the reason must be documented. A HIGH score must never be silently ignored.

10. Audit and review

Operations management reviews a sample of escalations monthly for timeliness, evidence quality, correct use of approvals, and false-positive patterns. Policy changes require a version update and effective date.

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